

L -functions for all meromorphic $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ modular forms, via manifestly finite contours

David A. McGady

Abstract

We give a single manifestly finite, regulator-free functional realizing in one object L -functions quasi-periods and period polynomials of meromorphic modular forms on $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$, with generic poles throughout the upper half-plane $\mathbb{H}$ and at the cusp of $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$. Additionally, our construction preserves holomorphicity. It is a two-segment contour integral, $L^*(f, s) = L_T^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^T) + L_S^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^S)$, where L_T^* and L_S^* have distinct integration kernels, and $\gamma_{\tau_0}^S$ is a path in $\mathbb{H}$ from $S(\tau_0)$ to τ_0 , and the same for $\gamma_{\tau_0}^T$. For weakly holomorphic forms our L -function is independent of τ_0 and of the path, and reproduces classical L -functions for holomorphic modular forms, reproduces the L -functions of weak modular forms in [1], which previously needed non-holomorphic regularization to be defined, and reproduces Brown's quasi-periods [2]. For properly meromorphic modular forms with poles inside the interior of $\mathbb{H}$, our L -function depends on the homotopy classes, defined in terms of pole-crossings. There is a natural choice of trivial homotopy class, which renders our L -functions canonical when the modular form has a pole in the interior of the fundamental domain, generalizing [3].

1 Introduction and preliminary concepts

Our primary goal in this note is to put forth a unifying generalization of the L -function associated to a given modular form. Our L -function naturally encompasses the classical case of L -functions associated to holomorphic modular forms [4], and seamlessly unifies Ref. [1]'s extension to L -functions of modular forms with poles at the cusp with Ref. [3]'s extension to L -functions of modular forms with poles at finite locations, exclusively away from cusps. Secondarily, we show that our L -functions reproduce the numerical results for quasi-periods associated to weak cusp forms [2].

Note: Throughout this document, we refer to L -integrals and L -functions. The classical L -function-as-Dirichlet-series which has been suitably extended to the complex s plane is simply not defined when the L -function in question has poles either at the cusp or at finite locations within the upper half-plane. So, if there is ever a doubt, we state clearly: *any L -function in this note is defined by an L -integral*. The focus of this note is to define L -integrals for any integer weight $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ modular form which may have poles at cusps or away from cusps.

1.1 Modular forms

Write $\mathrm{Re}(z)$ and $\mathrm{Im}(z)$ for the real and imaginary parts of a complex number $z \in \mathbb{C}$. Let $\mathbb{H} := \{\tau \in \mathbb{C} \mid \mathrm{Im}(\tau) > 0\}$ denote the upper half-plane. $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ is the group generated by $T := \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$ and $S := \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$.

A *holomorphic modular form* of weight k for $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ is a holomorphic function $f : \mathbb{H} \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ such that $f(\tau+1) = f(-\frac{1}{\tau})\tau^{-k} = f(\tau)$ for all $\tau \in \mathbb{H}$, and $f(\tau) = \mathcal{O}(1)$ as $\mathrm{Im}(\tau) \rightarrow \infty$, and which has no poles at finite locations within $\mathbb{H}$. By virtue of the periodicity $f(\tau) = f(\tau+1)$ and holomorphicity,

each holomorphic modular form has a q-series decomposition,

$$f(\tau) = \sum_n c_f(n) e^{2\pi i n \tau} = \sum_n c_f(n) q^n, \quad q := e^{2\pi i \tau}. \quad (1)$$

In order for f to be bounded as $\tau \rightarrow i\infty$, we conclude that $c_f(n) = 0$ for all $n < 0$, i.e. that $f = \sum_{n \geq 0} c_f(n) q^n$; for such modular forms f we write $f \in M_k$. If a modular form f additionally has a vanishing constant term, i.e. if $c_f(0) = 0$, then f is a *cusp form*, and we write $f \in S_k$. Clearly, $S_k \subset M_k$. Further, M_k is a finite-dimensional vector-space, as is S_k . Holomorphic $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ modular forms must have even integer weights, and $k \geq 4$ [4].

A product of modular forms of weights k_1 and k_2 is a modular form of weight $k_1 + k_2$, so $M_* := \bigoplus_k M_k$ is naturally a (graded) ring. This graded ring is freely generated by the two modular forms $E_4 \in M_4$ and $E_6 \in M_6$, the $k = 4, 6$ specializations of the *weight k Eisenstein series* E_k , which may be defined as follows:

$$E_k := \frac{1}{2} \sum_{(m,n)=1} \frac{1}{(m+n\tau)^k} = 1 - \frac{2k}{B_k} \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \sigma_{k-1}(n) q^n, \quad (2)$$

where $\sum_{(m,n)=1}$ denotes summing over all relatively prime $(m, n) \in \mathbb{Z}^2$, the Bernoulli number B_n is the coefficient of $t^n/n!$ of the Laurent expansion of $t/(e^t - 1)$ about $t = 0$, and $\sigma_m(n) := \sum_{d|n} d^m$ is the Divisor function where $d|n$ means $n/d \in \mathbb{N}$. In short, $M_* = \mathbb{C}[E_4, E_6]$. We now define the *modular discriminant*:

$$\Delta := \frac{E_4^3 - E_6^2}{1728} = q + O(q^2) \in S_{12}. \quad (3)$$

Holomorphicity is most canonically relaxed via allowing a modular form to have a pole at the cusp of $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$, i.e. for a weight k modular form for $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ to have negative powers of q in its q-series expansion. In this case, f diverges as $\tau \rightarrow i\infty$ as $f \sim e^{-2\pi N \tau}$, where $-N$ is the largest negative number such that $c_f(n)$ is non-zero. Such a modular form f is called a *weak modular form*, and we write $f \in M_k^!$. If a weak modular form f has a vanishing coefficient of q^0 , i.e. if $c_f(0) = 0$, it is called a *weak cusp form* and we write $f \in S_k^!$. Clearly, $S_k^! \subset M_k^!$, $S_k \subset S_k^!$ and $M_k \subset M_k^!$. Two important weak cusp forms in our paper are as follows:

$$J := \frac{E_4^3}{\Delta} - 744 = \frac{1}{q} + O(q) \in S_0^!, \quad (4)$$

$$\widehat{\Delta} = (J^2 + a_1 J + a_0) \Delta := \frac{1}{q} + O(q^2) \in S_{12}^!, \quad (5)$$

where a_0, a_1 are integers which exist to ensure the q-series gap that defines $\widehat{\Delta}$ [5].

In this work, we further relax from even weakly holomorphic modular forms, and consider *meromorphic modular forms* of weight k which are quotients: $f = \frac{f_1}{f_2}$ where $f_i \in M_{k_i}$, the denominator f_2 is not identically zero, and $k = k_1 - k_2$. We write F_k for the vector space of meromorphic modular forms of weight k , and set $F_* := \bigoplus_k F_k$. Then F_k vanishes unless k is an even integer, and F_* may be regarded as a “graded ring of fractions” of M_* .

1.2 L-functions for holomorphic modular forms and periods for cusp forms

For any $f \in S_k$, one may define the associated L-function:

$$L(f, s) := \frac{(2\pi)^s}{\Gamma(s)} L^*(f, s) \stackrel{f \in S_k}{:=} \frac{(2\pi)^s}{\Gamma(s)} \int_0^\infty f(it) t^{s-1} dt = \sum_{n \geq 1} \frac{c_f(n)}{n^s}. \quad (6)$$

A similar definition applies for $f \in M_k$. (The classical definition of $L^*(f, s)$ for $f \in M_k$ is the focus of Remark 3.6, below.) Similarly, one may define a period polynomial for $f \in S_k$ in terms of this L-function,

$$r_f(X, Y) := (2\pi i)^{k-1} \sum_{\ell=0}^{k-2} (-1)^\ell \binom{k-2}{\ell} i^{\ell+1} L^*(f, \ell+1) X^{k-2-\ell} Y^\ell. \quad (7)$$

This polynomial, $r_f(X, Y) \in V_{k-2} := \mathbb{C}[X, Y]_{k-2}$, has a natural action under $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$, $(P|_\gamma)(X, Y) = P(aX + bY, cX + dY)$ for $\gamma = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$. This period polynomial can be decomposed into a basis of highly constrained polynomials, which are annihilated by $|(1+T)|$ and $|(1+U+U^2)|$ [6], where $U := TS$ generates an order-3 cyclic subgroup of $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$. We define the *periods* of a cusp form to be the coefficients that localize r_f within this highly constrained sub-space of V_{k-2} .

Why this paper? As classically computed, these L-functions and associated period polynomials (when defined in terms of the special values of the associated L-function) are not defined when f has poles either at the cusp of $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ or within the interior of $\mathbb{H}$. As stated above, there are extant, but partial and non-overlapping, extensions of the definition of $L(f, s)$ to $f \in M_k^!$ [1] or $f \in F_k$ when f is regular at the cusp of $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ [3]. In this note, we provide a construction that unifies these disparate extensions. We start with generic L-integrals in section 2, then specialize to $f \in M_k^!$ in section 3, and finally explore the more general context of $f \in F_k$ in section 4.

2 A finite L-integral

Definition 2.1. Let $\tau_0 \in \mathbb{H}$ and $f \in F_k$, let $S = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$, $T = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$ denote the generators of $\Gamma = \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$, and let $f^{-1}(\infty)$ be the locus of all poles of $f \in \mathbb{H}$ (inclusive of the cusp of $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$). The S - and T -segments at τ_0 are smooth paths in $\mathbb{H} \setminus \Gamma \cdot f^{-1}(\infty)$ from $\sigma^{-1}\tau_0$ to τ_0 ,

$$\gamma_{\tau_0}^S : -1/\tau_0 \longrightarrow \tau_0, \quad \gamma_{\tau_0}^T : \tau_0 - 1 \longrightarrow \tau_0. \quad (8)$$

Avoiding poles is automatic for $f \in M_k^!$, as long as the base-point τ_0 , is not at a cusp of $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$, i.e. there is only the trivial homotopy class. When $f \in F_k$, and f has poles at finite and non-zero imaginary heights, integration contours fall into nontrivial homotopy classes.

Definition 2.2. Let $\zeta(s, x) = \sum_{m \geq 0} (m+x)^{-s}$ as a function $\zeta : \mathbb{C}_s \times (\mathbb{C} \setminus \mathbb{N})_x \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ denote the Hurwitz zeta function (meromorphic in s , holomorphic in $x \in \mathbb{H}$). We define Hurwitz T -kernel as

$$\tilde{k}_T(\tau, s) := \zeta(1-s, \tau+1) - e^{i\pi(s-1)} \zeta(1-(k-s), \tau+1). \quad (9)$$

Definition 2.3 (Generic L-integral). Let $f \in F_k$, $\tau_0 \in \mathbb{H}$, and $s \in \mathbb{C}$. Further, let $\gamma_{\tau_0}^S, \gamma_{\tau_0}^T$ be the S - and T -segments at τ_0 , as in Definition 2.1, and let k_T be as defined in Definition 2.2. The L-integral of f is

$$L^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^S, \gamma_{\tau_0}^T) := L_S^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^S) + L_T^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^T) := e^{-\pi i s/2} \left(\int_{\gamma_{\tau_0}^S} f(\tau) \tau^{s-1} d\tau + \int_{\gamma_{\tau_0}^T} f(\tau) \tilde{k}_T(\tau, s) d\tau \right) \quad (10)$$

We use this L -integral to define a generalized L -function:

Definition 2.4 (Generic L-function). Let $L^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^S, \gamma_{\tau_0}^T)$ be as defined in Definition 2.3. We define the generalized L -function of $f \in F_k$ to be,

$$L(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^S, \gamma_{\tau_0}^T) := \frac{(2\pi)^s}{\Gamma(s)} L^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^S, \gamma_{\tau_0}^T). \quad (11)$$

Having defined the L-integral and L-function, we prove they are manifestly finite for $f \in F_k$:

Lemma 2.5 (Finiteness of L-integrals). *For $f \in F_k$, both integrals in Definition 2.3 are finite for every $s \in \mathbb{C}$, every $\tau_0 \in \mathbb{H}$, and every choice of paths $\gamma_{\tau_0}^S, \gamma_{\tau_0}^T$.*

Proof. Both segments are compact and lie in $\mathbb{H} \setminus \Gamma \cdot f^{-1}(\infty)$, so f is continuous on them; τ^{s-1} is continuous on $\mathbb{H}$, and $\tilde{k}_T(\tau, s)$ is continuous there since $\zeta(\nu, \tau + 1)$ is holomorphic in $\tau \in \mathbb{H}$ (Definition 2.2). A continuous integrand on a compact path is integrable, for every $s \in \mathbb{C}$. $\square$

We now turn to path-dependence and τ_0 -independence of the L-integral and the L-function of $f \in F_k$. This holds for all $f \in M_k^!$:

Proposition 2.6 (Basepoint & path independence). *For $f \in M_k^!$ the value $L^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^S, \gamma_{\tau_0}^T)$ is independent of $\tau_0 \in \mathbb{H}$ and of the paths: with no interior poles, $\mathbb{H}$ is simply connected, so all admissible contours are homotopic. We write $L^*(f, s)$ for the common value and $L(f, s) := \frac{(2\pi)^s}{\Gamma(s)} L^*(f, s)$.*

Proof. With no interior poles the integrands $f(\tau)\tau^{s-1}$ and $f(\tau)\tilde{k}_T(\tau, s)$ are holomorphic on $\mathbb{H}$, which is simply connected; by Cauchy's theorem each integral is unchanged under any deformation fixing its endpoints, hence depends on those endpoints alone. This is path-independence.

For independence of τ_0 show that variations in τ_0 for the S-term and T-term in $L^*(f, s)$ cancel, i.e. that $\partial_{\tau_0} L_S^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^S) = -\partial_{\tau_0} L_T^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^T)$. For L_T^* , note that the T -segment runs from $T^{-1}\tau_0 = \tau_0 - 1$ to τ_0 — two endpoints a unit apart, moving together with τ_0 — so by Leibniz's rule and the T -periodicity $f(\tau_0 - 1) = f(\tau_0)$,

$$\partial_{\tau_0} L_T^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^T) = f(\tau_0) \tilde{k}_T(\tau_0, s) - f(\tau_0 - 1) \tilde{k}_T(\tau_0 - 1, s) = f(\tau_0) \delta_T \tilde{k}_T(\tau_0 - 1, s), \quad (12)$$

where $\delta_T \tilde{k}_T(\tau, s) := \tilde{k}_T(\tau + 1, s) - \tilde{k}_T(\tau, s)$. This is the whole role of δ_T : the unit gap between the endpoints turns the ∂_{τ_0} boundary term into a unit shift of the kernel. That shift is elementary — the kernel was built for it — since $\zeta(\nu, x + 1) - \zeta(\nu, x) = -x^{-\nu}$ gives, on both terms at $x = \tau + 1$,

$$\delta_T \tilde{k}_T(\tau, s) = -(\tau + 1)^{s-1} + e^{i\pi(s-1)}(\tau + 1)^{k-1-s} \quad (13)$$

$$\implies \partial_{\tau_0} L_T^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^T) = f(\tau_0) [-\tau_0^{s-1} + e^{i\pi(s-1)}\tau_0^{k-1-s}]. \quad (14)$$

The S -segment runs $-1/\tau_0 \rightarrow \tau_0$; its lower endpoint moves with $\partial_{\tau_0}(-1/\tau_0) = \tau_0^{-2}$, so by Leibniz, the modularity $f(-1/\tau_0) = \tau_0^k f(\tau_0)$, and the phase $(-1/\tau_0)^{s-1} = e^{i\pi(s-1)}\tau_0^{1-s}$,

$$\partial_{\tau_0} L_S^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^S) = f(\tau_0)\tau_0^{s-1} - f(-1/\tau_0)(-1/\tau_0)^{s-1}\tau_0^{-2} = f(\tau_0)[\tau_0^{s-1} - e^{i\pi(s-1)}\tau_0^{k-1-s}]. \quad (15)$$

Thus τ_0 -variations are equal and opposite, $\partial_{\tau_0} L_S^* = -\partial_{\tau_0} L_T^*$. Thus $\partial_{\tau_0} L^* = \partial_{\tau_0} L_S^* + \partial_{\tau_0} L_T^* = 0$. $\square$

Remark 2.7 (Recovering the classical L-integral for $f \in S_k$). *Let $f \in S_k$. As $\tau_0 \rightarrow i\infty$, the S -segment maps onto the standard L-function contour, $[0, i\infty]$. Simultaneously, as $f(it) \sim e^{-2\pi t}$ as $t \rightarrow \infty$, the T -segment vanishes exponentially. Thus, in this limit, $L^*(f, s)$ exactly maps onto the classical L-function integral [4]:*

$$\lim_{\tau_0 \rightarrow i\infty} L^*(f, s) = \int_0^\infty t^{s-1} f(it) dt. \quad (16)$$

3 L -functions for weak modular forms

Proposition 3.1. Let $\Gamma(s, x) := \int_x^\infty e^{-t} t^{s-1} dt$ denote the incomplete Gamma function. For $n \neq 0$, $\nu \in \mathbb{C}$, and $z \in \mathbb{H}$,

$$\int_z^{z+1} e^{2\pi i n u} \zeta(\nu, u) du = e^{i\pi(1-\nu)/2} (2\pi n)^{\nu-1} \Gamma(1-\nu, -2\pi i n z). \quad (17)$$

Proof. Write $\zeta(\nu, u) = \sum_{m \geq 0} (m+u)^{-\nu}$ and shift $u \mapsto u+m$ in the m -th term; as $e^{2\pi i n(u+m)} = e^{2\pi i n u}$ for integer m , the unit segments stack into one horizontal ray,

$$\int_z^{z+1} e^{2\pi i n u} \zeta(\nu, u) du = \sum_{m \geq 0} \int_{z+m}^{z+1+m} e^{2\pi i n v} v^{-\nu} dv = \int_z^{z+\infty} e^{2\pi i n v} v^{-\nu} dv. \quad (18)$$

Substitute $w = -2\pi i n v$, so that $v = iw/(2\pi n)$, $dv = i dw/(2\pi n)$, and $e^{2\pi i n v} = e^{-w}$: the lower endpoint becomes $w = -2\pi i n z$, and for $n > 0$ the ray rotates to $w \rightarrow +\infty$ along the positive reals — legal, since $e^{-w} w^{-\nu}$ decays in the right half-plane, so the closing arc vanishes. With $v^{-\nu} = i^{-\nu} (2\pi n)^{\nu} w^{-\nu}$,

$$\int_z^{z+\infty} e^{2\pi i n v} v^{-\nu} dv = i^{1-\nu} (2\pi n)^{\nu-1} \int_{-2\pi i n z}^{\infty} e^{-w} w^{-\nu} dw = e^{i\pi(1-\nu)/2} (2\pi n)^{\nu-1} \Gamma(1-\nu, -2\pi i n z). \quad (19)$$

For $n < 0$ the ray instead grows as $\text{Im} v \rightarrow \infty$ and the rotation is illegal; but both sides are analytic in n and agree for $n > 0$, so the identity continues to $n < 0$ with Γ on its principal branch. At $n = 0$ the prefactor $(2\pi n)^{\nu-1}$ is singular; that case is handled separately. $\square$

Theorem 3.2 (The L -function for $f \in M_k^1$). For $f \in M_k^1$, we may set $\tau_0 = i$, and prove

$$L^*(f, s) = -c_f(0) \left(\frac{1}{s} + \frac{i^k}{k-s} \right) + \sum_{n \neq 0} c_f(n) \left(\frac{\Gamma(s, 2\pi n)}{(2\pi n)^s} + i^k \frac{\Gamma(k-s, 2\pi n)}{(2\pi n)^{k-s}} \right). \quad (20)$$

Here, trivially, $L^*(f, s) = i^k L^*(f, k-s)$. The L -function is $L(f, s) := (2\pi)^s L^*(f, s)/\Gamma(s)$.

Proof. By path independence and base-point independence from Proposition 2.6, we may freely set $\tau_0 = i$. Here, $L_S^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^S) = 0$ (the S -contour vanishes in length and there are no nontrivial homotopy classes as $f \in M_k^1$ has no poles which a finite contour can wrap), and the L -integral simplifies dramatically:

$$L^*(f, s) = L_T^*(f, s; \gamma_i^T) = e^{-\pi i s/2} \int_{i-1}^i f(\tau) \tilde{k}_T(\tau, s) d\tau. \quad (21)$$

We then expand f in terms of its q -series, $\sum_n c_f(n) e^{2\pi i n \tau}$, and substitute the u -variable of Proposition 3.1 as $u = \tau + 1$, and note that $e^{2\pi i n(u-1)} = e^{2\pi i n u}$. When $n \neq 0$, straightforward substitutions of ν, z into Proposition 3.1 suffice: $1-\nu = s$ gives the contribution of the first term in $\tilde{k}_T(\tau, s)$, and $1-\nu = k-s$ gives the second:

$$e^{-\pi i s/2} \left(e^{\pi i s/2} \frac{\Gamma(s, 2\pi n)}{(2\pi n)^s} - e^{i\pi(s-1)} e^{\pi i(k-s)/2} \frac{\Gamma(k-s, 2\pi n)}{(2\pi n)^{k-s}} \right) = \frac{\Gamma(s, 2\pi n)}{(2\pi n)^s} + i^k \frac{\Gamma(k-s, 2\pi n)}{(2\pi n)^{k-s}}. \quad (22)$$

We may then evaluate the $n = 0$ mode's contribution follows from noting the closed form solution for the definite integral,

$$\int_{i-1}^i \zeta(\sigma, \tau + 1) d\tau = \int_i^{i+1} \zeta(\sigma, u) du = \frac{i^{1-\sigma}}{\sigma-1}. \quad (23)$$

This result follows from noting $\partial_a(\zeta(\sigma-1, a)/(1-\sigma)) = \zeta(\sigma, a)$ and $\zeta(\sigma-1, a+1) - \zeta(\sigma-1, a) = -a^{1-\sigma}$. Applying this to the two distinct terms of $\tilde{k}_T(\tau, s)$ at $\sigma = 1-s$ and $\sigma = 1-(k-s)$ gives

$$e^{-\pi is/2} \int_{i-1}^i c_f(0) \tilde{k}_T(\tau, s) d\tau = -c_f(0) \left(\frac{1}{s} + \frac{i^k}{k-s} \right). \quad (24)$$

Combining the $n=0$ contributions with the $n \neq 0$ contributions reproduces Eq. (20). Finally, the functional equation, $L^*(f, s) = i^k L^*(f, k-s)$, follows by direct inspection. $\square$

3.1 Explicit S- and T-contours for general τ_0

Lemma 3.3 (L_T^* for $M_k^!$). *For $f \in M_k^!$, and $\tau_0 \in \mathbb{H}$ away from cusps, $L_T^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^T)$ evaluates to:*

$$L_T^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^T) = -c_f(0) \left(\frac{(\tau_0/i)^s}{s} + i^k \frac{(\tau_0/i)^{k-s}}{k-s} \right) + \sum_{n \neq 0} c_f(n) \left(\frac{\Gamma(s, -2\pi in \tau_0)}{(2\pi n)^s} + i^k \frac{\Gamma(k-s, -2\pi in \tau_0)}{(2\pi n)^{k-s}} \right). \quad (25)$$

Proof. Expand $f = \sum_n c_f(n) q^n$ on the compact segment $[\tau_0-1, \tau_0]$, and restrict attention to the sub-sum, $\sum_{n \neq 0}$. For each such $n \neq 0$, apply the Proposition 3.1 in $\tilde{k}_T(\tau, s) = \zeta(1-s, \tau+1) - e^{i\pi(s-1)} \zeta(s-(k-1), \tau+1)$ at $\nu = 1-s$ and $\nu = s-(k-1)$. The phases for the second term work-out identically as in the proof of Theorem 3.2.

For $n=0$, the constant $c_f(0)$ multiplies $e^{-\pi is/2} \int_{\tau_0-1}^{\tau_0} \tilde{k}_T(\tau, s) d\tau$; the Hurwitz antiderivative $\int_{\tau_0-1}^{\tau_0} \zeta(\sigma, \tau+1) d\tau = \tau_0^{1-\sigma}/(\sigma-1) -$ from $\partial_\tau \zeta(\sigma-1, \tau+1) = -(\sigma-1)\zeta(\sigma, \tau+1)$ and the shift $\zeta(\sigma-1, \tau_0+1) - \zeta(\sigma-1, \tau_0) = -\tau_0^{1-\sigma}$ — applied to the two halves of $\tilde{k}_T$ at $\sigma = 1-s$ and $\sigma = s-k+1$ yields $-e^{-\pi is/2} \tau_0^s/s$ and $-e^{\pi is/2} \tau_0^{k-s}/(k-s)$ respectively. $\square$

Corollary 3.4 (L_T^* as $\tau_0 \rightarrow i\infty$). *Let $f \in S_k^!$, where $f = \sum_{n \geq -N} c_f(n) q^n$ for some $-N \in \mathbb{Z}$. The T-contour's contribution to $L^*(f, s)$ is given by Lemma 3.3. As $\tau_0 = it$ goes to the cusp $i\infty$, the T-contour scales exactly as $f(it)$ scales: $L_T^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^T) \sim f(it) \sim e^{2\pi Nt}$.*

Proof. For the asymptotics, $\Gamma(\sigma, z) \sim z^{\sigma-1} e^{-z}$ as $|z| \rightarrow \infty$ for $|\arg z| < \frac{3\pi}{2}$ [10, §8.11] gives $|c_f(n)|$ -weighted go as $e^{-2\pi n \text{Im}(\tau_0)}$. The smallest mode n in the q-series, i.e. $n = -N$, dominates the scaling of $f(it)$ and of $L_T^*(f, s; \gamma_{it}^T)$. Combining these results yields the claimed asymptotics. $\square$

Now, exploiting τ_0 -independence of $L^*(f, s)$, its explicit value as given in Theorem 3.2, and the explicit T-contribution $L_T^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^T)$ trivially implies clean, closed-form expressions for $L_S^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^S)$:

Corollary 3.5 (L_S^* for $M_k^!$). *For $f \in M_k^!$ and $\tau_0 \in \mathbb{H}$, $L_S^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^S)$ evaluates to*

$$L_S^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^S) = c_f(0) \left(\frac{(\tau_0/i)^s - 1}{s} + i^k \frac{(\tau_0/i)^{k-s} - 1}{k-s} \right) + \sum_{n \neq 0} c_f(n) \left(\frac{\Gamma(s, 2\pi n) - \Gamma(s, -2\pi in \tau_0)}{(2\pi n)^s} + i^k \frac{\Gamma(k-s, 2\pi n) - \Gamma(k-s, -2\pi in \tau_0)}{(2\pi n)^{k-s}} \right). \quad (26)$$

Proof. Recall $L^*(f, s) - L_T^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^T) = L_S^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^S)$. Now, $L^*(f, s)$ for $f \in M_k^!$ is given by Theorem 3.2, and $L_T^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^T)$ is given by Lemma 3.3. Their difference yields Eq. (26). $\square$

3.2 Classical Mellin recovery and canonical uniqueness.

As discussed in Remark 2.7, for $f \in S_k$, taking the cusp-limit $\tau_0 \rightarrow i\infty$ in Theorem 3.2 collapses the S -segment onto the classical Mellin contour $[0, i\infty]$ while via Corollary 3.4 the T -segment vanishes exponentially as $L_T^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^T) \sim f(\tau_0) \sim e^{-2\pi \text{Im}(\tau_0)N}$ (as $f \in S_k \Leftrightarrow f = \sum_{n \geq N} c_f(n)q^n$ with $N \geq 1$). I.e., here, one recovers the classical L-integral of f without obstruction:

$$\lim_{\tau_0 \rightarrow i\infty} L^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^S, \gamma_{\tau_0}^T) = \int_0^\infty t^{s-1} f(it) dt. \quad (27)$$

This story changes when $f = 1/q^N(1 + O(q)) \in S_k^!$ for some $N \geq 1$.

In this context, while of course the sum $L_T^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^T) + L_S^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^S) = L^*(f, s)$ is manifestly invariant under changes of the base-point, each of these two terms can indeed change values. Indeed, Corollary 3.4 clearly shows that as $\tau_0 \rightarrow i\infty$, when $f \in S_k^!$ has negative powers of q in its q -series, then $L_T^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^T) \sim e^{2\pi N \text{Im}(\tau_0)}$. Discarding $\gamma_{\tau_0}^T$ therefore does violence to the result: When the S -contour is isolated from its T -partner, and $\tau_0 \rightarrow i\infty$, it diverges. This is the precise reason that [1] needed to regularize their divergent L-integral representation for properly weak cusp forms.

Remark 3.6 (Recovering the classical L-integral for $f \in M_k$). *In textbook treatments [4], when $f \in M_k$, its L-integral is defined as*

$$\begin{aligned} L^*(f, s)|_{\text{cl}} &:= \int_0^\infty (f(it) - c_f(0))t^{s-1}dt = \frac{\Gamma(s)}{(2\pi)^s} \sum_{n=1}^\infty \frac{c_f(n)}{n^s} \\ &= -c_f(0) \left(\frac{1}{s} + \frac{i^k}{k-s} \right) + \sum_{n=1}^\infty c_f(n) \left(\frac{\Gamma(s, 2\pi n)}{(2\pi n)^s} + i^k \frac{\Gamma(k-s, 2\pi n)}{(2\pi n)^{k-s}} \right) \end{aligned} \quad (28)$$

Classically, this constant-term subtraction is needed because $\int_0^\infty t^{s-1}dt$ is a pure divergence, so the q -series cannot commute with the integration contour.

However, as is clear from our general Theorem 3.2 for L-integrals for $f \in M_k^!$, and from the specific results of the S - and T -contours in Lemma 3.3 and Corollary 3.5, our L-integral requires no such explicit subtraction of the constant term $-c_f(0)$. Thus, not only does our prescription naturally handle divergences at poles when $f \in M_k^!$ has polar terms in its q -series, but it also obviates the need to by-hand remove the constant mode from the kernel of the L-integral that is needed when defining L-functions in terms of the classical Mellin contour, $\int_0^\infty$.

3.3 Period polynomials, periods and quasi-periods

Because $L^*(f, s)$ is canonical for every $f \in S_k^!$, the period polynomial needs no separate construction — it is the generating polynomial of the critical values.

Definition 3.7 (Period polynomial for $S_k^!$). *For $f \in S_k^!$ and $n = k - 2$, the period polynomial is*

$$r_f(X, Y) := (2\pi i)^{n+1} \sum_{\ell=0}^n (-1)^\ell \binom{n}{\ell} i^{\ell+1} L^*(f, \ell+1) X^{n-\ell} Y^\ell. \quad (29)$$

Proposition 3.8 (Period polynomial as a contour integral). *With $(X - \tau Y)^n$ in place of the L -weight τ^{s-1} , and $\mathbf{K}_T(\tau; X, Y) := \sum_{\ell=0}^n \binom{n}{\ell} (-1)^\ell k_T(\tau, \ell+1) X^{n-\ell} Y^\ell$ in place of $\tilde{k}_T$, the same two segments assemble r_f directly:*

$$r_f(X, Y) = (2\pi i)^{n+1} \left[\int_{\gamma_{\tau_0}^S} f(\tau) (X - \tau Y)^n d\tau + \int_{\gamma_{\tau_0}^T} f(\tau) \mathbf{K}_T(\tau; X, Y) d\tau \right]. \quad (30)$$

Proof. By Definition 2.3, the $X^{n-\ell}Y^\ell$ coefficient of the bracket is

$$r_f|_{X^{n-\ell}Y^\ell} = (-1)^\ell \binom{n}{\ell} i^{\ell+1} [L_S^*(f, \ell+1) + L_T^*(f, \ell+1)] = (-1)^\ell \binom{n}{\ell} i^{\ell+1} L^*(f, \ell+1). \quad (31)$$

This matches definition 3.7 term by term, and proves the claim. $\square$

Remark 3.9 (The role of the T -kernel in Eichler–Shimura theory). *The Hurwitz T -kernel in this note was originally uncovered in order to reproduce the manifestly finite computations of the quasi-periods for $\tilde{\Delta} = 1/q + O(q^2) \in S_{12}^1$ originally given in [2]. Its role in the period polynomial (30) is sharp: the S -segment alone is not invariant under the parabolic shift $\tau_0 \mapsto \tau_0 + 1$, and the T -segment $\int_{\gamma_{\tau_0}^T} f(\tau) \mathbf{K}_T(\tau; X, Y) d\tau$ is precisely the term that cancels this variation, leaving $r_f(X, Y)$ independent of the basepoint τ_0 (Proposition 2.6). This basepoint-independence is the finite-contour counterpart of the parabolicity condition in Eichler–Shimura theory.*

Extraction via the Kohnen–Zagier basis. For k with $\dim S_k = 1$, the degree- $(k-2)$ polynomials annihilated by $1+S$ and $1+U+U^2$ ($U=TS$) form a three-dimensional space: an even and an odd cuspidal generator, together with the Eisenstein polynomial $p_0 = X^{k-2} - Y^{k-2}$ [6, §1.3].

Definition 3.10. $W_\pm^{(k)}$ are the even and odd cuspidal generators of this space, normalized to primitive integer coefficients (explicit forms in Appendix A).

Explicitly, with $B_m^0(X) = \sum_{i \neq 1} \binom{m}{i} B_i X^{m-i}$ the m th Bernoulli polynomial minus its linear term, $\tilde{j} = n - j$ ($n = k - 2$), and $p_0 = X^n - 1$, they are the primitive-integer representatives of the Kohnen–Zagier period polynomials [6, Thm. 1']

$$r_j^- = \frac{1}{\tilde{j}+1} (B_{\tilde{j}+1}^0(X) + X^n B_{\tilde{j}+1}^0(\frac{1}{X})) - \frac{1}{\tilde{j}+1} (B_{j+1}^0(X) + X^n B_{j+1}^0(\frac{1}{X})) \quad (j \text{ even}), \quad (32)$$

$$r_j^+ = \frac{1}{\tilde{j}+1} (B_{\tilde{j}+1}^0(X) - X^n B_{\tilde{j}+1}^0(\frac{1}{X})) + \frac{1}{\tilde{j}+1} (B_{j+1}^0(X) - X^n B_{j+1}^0(\frac{1}{X})) - \frac{k}{B_k} \frac{B_{j+1} B_{\tilde{j}+1}}{(\tilde{j}+1)(j+1)} p_0 \quad (j \text{ odd}),$$

which for $\dim S_k = 1$ span the odd and even cuspidal lines independently of the interior index j : $W_-^{(k)} \propto r_j^-$, and $W_+^{(k)}$ is the cuspidal representative of r_j^+ (modulo p_0). The periods are the basis-invariant Haberland projections

$$\omega^\pm = \frac{\langle r_{\Delta_k}, W_\pm^{(k)} \rangle}{\langle W_\pm^{(k)}, W_\pm^{(k)} \rangle}, \quad \langle P, Q \rangle = \sum_a (-1)^a \binom{n}{a}^{-1} p_a q_{n-a}. \quad (33)$$

The cusp form's period polynomial lies in $W_+ \oplus W_-$; the weak form's carries an additional even coboundary, so η^- is read off directly while η^+ is well-defined only through the projection (32), which removes it. Appendix A gives the bases and projections weight by weight.

Remark 3.11 (External check: the Petersson norm). *That the extracted periods are the classical critical periods is confirmed by a check independent of the $W_\pm$ normalization: the coboundary-free cusp-form periods $r_m(\Delta_k) = \int_0^{i\infty} \tau^m \Delta_k(\tau) d\tau = i^{m+1} L^*(\Delta_k, m+1)$ must obey Haberland's formula*

$$-6(-2i)^{k-2} \langle f, f \rangle = \sum_{m+n \leq k-2} \binom{k-2}{m+n} \binom{m+n}{m} (-1)^m \operatorname{Im}(r_m(f) \overline{r_n(f)}), \quad (34)$$

which recovers the Petersson norm $\langle f, f \rangle$ [8, Thm. 5.2]. Ours do: for Δ ($k = 12$) the L^* -values reproduce Zagier's $\langle \Delta, \Delta \rangle = 1.03536 \dots \times 10^{-6}$ to 14 digits; at $k = 16$ they match the fundamental-domain integral $\int_{\mathcal{F}} |f|^2 y^{k-2} dx dy = 2.16906 \dots \times 10^{-6}$ to 16 digits.

Quasi-periods and their determinant: It is interesting to collect the quasi-periods computable from our L-integrals/period-polynomials for $f \in S_k^!$ (when $\dim(S_k) = 1$).

To this effect, we recall the notation of [5]. Decomposing the modular weight $k = 12\lambda + k'$ where $k' \in \{0, 4, 6, 8, 10, 14\}$, we see $\lambda = \dim(S_k)$ when $\lambda \geq 0$. For any λ , we may denote $f_{k,m} := 1/q^m + O(q^{\lambda+1}) \in M_k^!$. When $\dim(S_k) = 1$, we have $f_{k,m} = 1/q^m + O(q^2)$. Here, define $\Delta_k := f_{k,-1} = q + O(q^2) \in S_k$ and $\hat{\Delta}_k := f_{k,1} = 1/q + O(q^2) \in S_k^!$. Further, define

$$\text{pd}_k := \begin{pmatrix} \omega^+(\Delta_k) & \omega^-(\Delta_k) \\ \eta^+(\hat{\Delta}_k) & \eta^-(\hat{\Delta}_k) \end{pmatrix}, \quad \alpha_k := \frac{(-1)^{1+k/2} \det(\text{pd}_k)}{(2\pi i)^{k-1} (k-2)!} \quad (35)$$

Brown–Hain [7, Prop. 5.6] show that $\det(\text{pd}_k)$ satisfies a Legendre-type relation, $\det(\text{pd}_k) \in \mathbb{Q}^\times \cdot (2\pi i)^{k-1}$. Brown [2, §8.3] numerically finds $\alpha_k = 1$; we reproduce this result at $k = 12$ and give the analogous rational multiples for $k \in \{16, 18, 20, 22, 26\}$ in Table 1, below. The value of α_k is tied to the normalization of Definition ??: our primitive-integer choice reproduces Brown’s $\alpha_{12} = 1$, whereas rescaling the same lines to the Kohnen–Zagier polynomials $r^\pm(R_n)$ [6, Thm. 1']—whose R_n normalization is itself n -dependent—gives different α_k and spoils $\alpha_{12} = 1$. The α_k are therefore basis-relative rationals.

k	$\omega^+(\Delta_k)$	$\omega^-(\Delta_k)/i$	$\eta^+(\hat{\Delta}_k)$	$\eta^-(\hat{\Delta}_k)/i$	α_k
12	−6.89168e7	−5.58502e6	1.27202e11	1.02767e10	1
16	−8.81481e11	−1.54063e10	4.14120e13	6.83541e11	13/30
18	−5.07833e13	−5.43305e12	−2.19200e14	−3.36339e13	2/3
20	−4.22882e16	−3.73170e14	6.38640e16	−1.89823e14	17/5
22	−1.49974e18	−4.24489e16	1.43795e18	−4.41050e16	19/21
26	−1.18673e22	−3.60961e21	1.18653e22	−3.61016e21	23/15

Table 1: Periods $\omega^\pm(\Delta_k)$ and quasi-periods $\eta^\pm(\hat{\Delta}_k)$, and the rational number α_k . While $\alpha_{12} = 1$ matches Brown [2], α_k for $k \geq 16$ appear to be new, interesting, rational numbers, albeit with implicit dependence on the period-polynomial basis normalizations—in contrast to the normalization-free Petersson check above. We have not found a clear pattern for the α_k . See [9] for the scripts that extracted these figures (to 50-digit precision).

4 Meromorphic modular forms

For $f \in F_k$ with poles in $\mathbb{H}$, the two segment integrals of Definition 2.3 depend on their contours; we show their sum depends only on the homotopy class of the pair.

Proposition 4.1. *For $f \in F_k$ and $\tau_0 \in \mathbb{H} \setminus \Gamma \cdot f^{-1}(\infty)$, the L-integral $L^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^S, \gamma_{\tau_0}^T)$ depends only on the homotopy class of its two segments in $\mathbb{H} \setminus \Gamma \cdot f^{-1}(\infty)$, and not on the basepoint τ_0 . At fixed τ_0 each of L_S^*, L_T^* is separately path-independent; a change of basepoint moves value between the two, leaving only their sum invariant.*

Proof. At fixed τ_0 the integrands $f(\tau)\tau^{s-1}$ and $f(\tau)\tilde{k}_T(\tau, s)$ are holomorphic on $\mathbb{H} \setminus \Gamma \cdot f^{-1}(\infty)$, so Cauchy’s theorem makes each of L_S^*, L_T^* constant on the homotopy class of its own segment. Under a motion of the basepoint, $\partial_{\tau_0} L^*$ is evaluated at the moving endpoints alone; the computation of Proposition 2.6 — which uses only $f(\tau_0 - 1) = f(\tau_0)$ and $f(-1/\tau_0) = \tau_0^k f(\tau_0)$ — cancels the boundary terms of L_S^* against those of L_T^* , the interior poles lying off the contours. Hence $\partial_{\tau_0} L^* = 0$ along any motion in $\mathbb{H} \setminus \Gamma \cdot f^{-1}(\infty)$, while each summand separately varies. $\square$

Definition 4.2. *For $f \in F_k$ and $\tau_0 \in \mathbb{H} \setminus \Gamma \cdot f^{-1}(\infty)$, let $[\gamma_{\tau_0}^S], [\gamma_{\tau_0}^T]$ denote the homotopy classes of the two segments in $\mathbb{H} \setminus \Gamma \cdot f^{-1}(\infty)$.*

Thus, with $\gamma_{\tau_0}^S \in [\gamma_{\tau_0}^S]$ and $\gamma_{\tau_0}^T \in [\gamma_{\tau_0}^T]$, by Proposition 4.1 the value

$$L^*(f, s; [\gamma_{\tau_0}^S], [\gamma_{\tau_0}^T]) := L^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^S, \gamma_{\tau_0}^T) = L_S^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^S) + L_T^*(f, s; \gamma_{\tau_0}^T) \quad (36)$$

is independent of the chosen representative paths and independent of τ_0 (subject to natural constraints of τ_0 monodromies around singular points, which move between homotopy classes).

We would like to speak of “the” L-integral. Homotopy classes of course split this into L-integrals for contours in different homotopy classes. And, so, in what follows, we define the reference homotopy classes:

Definition 4.3. Let $f \in F_k$, τ_0 be the base-point of $L^*(f, s)$ in the usual way, and let $f^{-1}(\infty)$ be the full set of all poles of f . Further, let τ_p^* denote the pole of lowest height at/above the $\text{Im}(\tau) = 1$ line, and denote its imaginary height by $y^* := \text{Im}(\tau_p^*)$. If $y^* = 1$, then let $\tau_p^\dagger = x^\dagger + iy^\dagger$ denote f ’s pole of next lowest height above τ_p^* . I.e., $y^* < y^\dagger$; if no such pole exists, then $y^\dagger := \infty$.

We define the minimal homotopy class of f , which we denote $[\gamma_f] = [\gamma_f^T] + [\gamma_f^S]$, as follows.

1. If $y^* > 1$, then $[\gamma_f^T]$ is the homotopy class containing the horizontal line from $i - 1$ to i , and $[\gamma_f^S]$ is the homotopy class containing the trivial path from i to itself.
2. If $y^* = 1$, let δ be any positive constant such that $y^* < 1 + \delta < y^\dagger$. Let $\tau_0^* := i + i\delta$. Here, $[\gamma_f^T]$ is the homotopy class containing the horizontal line from $\tau_0^* - 1$ to τ_0^* , and $[\gamma_f^S]$ is the homotopy class containing the almost-straight-line path that goes from $-1/\tau_0^*$ to τ_0^* along the imaginary- τ axis except when it passes a pole on the axis. When there is a pole on the imaginary- τ axis e.g. at $\tau_p = i$, this special contour $\gamma_{\tau_0^*}^S$ passes to the left of such a pole.

With this definition, we may thus unambiguously define

$$L^*(f, s) := L^*(f, s; [\gamma_f^S], [\gamma_f^T]) . \quad (37)$$

Now, having fixed the reference value $L_0^*(f, s)$ in the trivial homotopy class in Definition 4.3, now consider two paths $\gamma_{\tau_0}^S$ and $\gamma_{\tau_0}^T$ which may be in any homotopy class. Further, let $X_S(p), X_T(p) \in \mathbb{Z}$ count the windings $\gamma_{\tau_0}^S$, resp. $\gamma_{\tau_0}^T$ has about each pole $\tau_p \in f^{-1}(\infty)$ relative to the null-classes.

Lemma 4.4. Let $f \in F_k$, $r_S(f, \tau_p) := \text{Res}_{\tau=\tau_p}(f(\tau)\tau^{s-1})$ and $r_T(f, \tau_p) := \text{Res}_{\tau=\tau_p}(f(\tau)\tilde{k}_T(\tau, s))$. Then,

$$L^*(f, s; [\gamma_{\tau_0}^S], [\gamma_{\tau_0}^T]) = L_0^*(f, s) + 2\pi i e^{-\pi i s/2} \sum_{\tau_p \in f^{-1}(\infty)} \left[X_S(\tau_p) r_S(f, \tau_p) + X_T(\tau_p) r_T(f, \tau_p) \right]. \quad (38)$$

Proof. Two pairs whose winding data differ by one unit at a single pole p , on one segment, bound a loop encircling p once; the residue theorem adds $2\pi i$ times the residue of that segment’s integrand — $f\tau^{s-1}$ for γ^S , $f\tilde{k}_T$ for γ^T — and the prefactor $e^{-\pi i s/2}$ of Definition 2.3 multiplies through. Within-class constancy is Proposition 4.1; summing over crossings gives (37). $\square$

The polylog projection renders every pole with $\text{Im} \tau_p \geq 1$ as an explicit tail, leaving $(I - \hat{P})f$ with all poles strictly below the line $\text{Im} \tau = 1$. This is forced for poles with $\text{Im} \tau_p > 1$: lying above γ_f^T , they make the q -series of f diverge on the contour ($|c_f(n)| \gtrsim n^{m-1} e^{2\pi n \text{Im} \tau_p}$ for a pole of order m [3]). A pole on the line itself sits just below the lifted γ_f^T of Definition 4.3; we project it too, so the regularized part stays clean and it appears as a tail rather than a γ^S -integral around the pole.

Definition 4.5. Let $f \in F_k$ have, at a pole τ_p of order m_p , the Laurent principal part $\sum_{m=1}^{m_p} a_{-m}^{(p)} (\tau - \tau_p)^{-m}$, where $a_{-m}^{(p)}$ is the coefficient of $(\tau - \tau_p)^{-m}$. Since $\text{Li}_{1-m}(e^{2\pi i(\tau - \tau_p)})$ has a pole of order m at τ_p , there are unique $r_{f, \tau_p}^*(m)$, $1 \leq m \leq m_p$, for which the polylog projection

$$\widehat{P}_{\tau_p} f(\tau) := \sum_{m=1}^{m_p} r_{f, \tau_p}^*(m) \text{Li}_{1-m}(e^{2\pi i(\tau - \tau_p)}) \quad (39)$$

has the same principal part as f at τ_p (a triangular, hence invertible, linear system relating $r_{f, \tau_p}^*(m)$ to $a_{-1}^{(p)}, \dots, a_{-m}^{(p)}$). The projection $\widehat{P} := \sum_{\text{Im} \tau_p \geq 1} \widehat{P}_{\tau_p}$ removes the principal part of every pole with $\text{Im} \tau_p \geq 1$.

Definition 4.6. With $\widehat{P}$ as in Definition 4.5, let $c_{Rf}(n)$ be the Fourier coefficients of the regularized form $(I - \widehat{P})f$ in its expansion valid for large $\text{Im} \tau$:

$$(I - \widehat{P})f(\tau) = \sum_n c_{Rf}(n) q^n, \quad q = e^{2\pi i \tau}. \quad (40)$$

Definition 4.7. $F(\infty)$ is the space of meromorphic g on $\mathbb{H}$ with $g(\tau + 1) = g(\tau)$, finitely many poles in each compact subset of $\{\text{Im} \tau > 0, |\text{Re} \tau| \leq \frac{1}{2}\}$, and $g(\tau) = O(e^{C \text{Im} \tau})$ as $\text{Im} \tau \rightarrow \infty$ for some C .

Then $F_k \subset F(\infty)$, and $(I - \widehat{P})f \in F(\infty)$: the polylog tails are T -periodic but not modular, so the projection leaves F_k . After projection every pole of $(I - \widehat{P})f$ lies strictly below $\text{Im} \tau = 1$; pole heights accumulate only at 0, so there is a maximal one, $y_b < 1$ (take $y_b = 0$ if $(I - \widehat{P})f$ is holomorphic).

Lemma 4.8. Let $y_b < 1$ be the maximal pole height of $(I - \widehat{P})f$, and m_b the maximal order among poles at height y_b . There is a $C > 0$ such that, for every $\varepsilon > 0$,

$$C n^{m_b-1} e^{2\pi n y_b} \leq |c_{Rf}(n)| \leq e^{2\pi n(y_b + \varepsilon)}, \quad (41)$$

the upper bound for all large n , the lower for infinitely many n . In particular $|c_{Rf}(n)| e^{-2\pi n} \rightarrow 0$ geometrically, at base $e^{-2\pi(1-y_b-\varepsilon)}$.

Proof. $(I - \widehat{P})f$ is T -periodic and continuous on $\text{Im} \tau = y$ for each $y \in (y_b, 1]$, so Parseval gives $\int_{-1/2}^{1/2} |(I - \widehat{P})f(\sigma + iy)|^2 d\sigma = \sum_n |c_{Rf}(n) e^{-2\pi y n}|^2 < \infty$, whence $c_{Rf}(n) e^{-2\pi y n} \rightarrow 0$; $y = y_b + \varepsilon$ gives the upper bound [3]. For the lower bound, subtract the polylog projection of the height- y_b poles: the remainder's coefficients are $o(e^{2\pi n y_b})$, while the subtracted tails contribute $\sum_j C_j n^{m_j-1} e^{-2\pi i n x_j} e^{2\pi n y_b}$ with $C_j \neq 0$ at order m_b ; the x_j distinct mod 1, the mean value $\sum_{m_j=m_b} |C_j|^2 > 0$ bounds the sum below along infinitely many n . $\square$

For $n \neq 0$, the single-mode contribution of Theorem 3.2 is

$$G_{s,k}(n) := \frac{\Gamma(s, 2\pi n)}{(2\pi n)^s} + i^k \frac{\Gamma(k-s, 2\pi n)}{(2\pi n)^{k-s}}. \quad (42)$$

Each projected pole contributes a single polylog tail.

Definition 4.9. With $\text{Li}_s(x) = \sum_{n \geq 1} x^n n^{-s}$, the tail integral of a projected pole at z with $\text{Im} z > 1$ is the L -integral of that tail in the minimal class of f (Definition 4.3):

$$I_N(s, z) := L^*(\text{Li}_{-N}(e^{2\pi i(\cdot - z)}), s; [\gamma_f^S], [\gamma_f^T]). \quad (43)$$

The tail's poles then lie above γ_f^S , whose contribution vanishes, so $I_N(s, z)$ is the T -segment integral alone.

Lemma 4.10. For $\text{Im } z > 1$, polylog inversion $\text{Li}_{-N}(w) = (-1)^{N+1} \text{Li}_{-N}(1/w)$ resums (42) into

$$I_N(s, z) = \delta_{N,0} \left(\frac{1}{s} + \frac{i^k}{k-s} \right) + (-1)^{N+1} \sum_{n \geq 1} n^N e^{2\pi i n z} G_{s,k}(-n), \quad (44)$$

convergent exponentially with base $e^{-2\pi(\text{Im } z - 1)}$.

Proof. By Proposition 4.1 we may evaluate $I_N(s, z)$ in the $\delta \rightarrow 0$ representative of the minimal class; there the tail — regular at i since $\text{Im } z > 1$ — has vanishing γ_f^S -integral and $\gamma_f^T \rightarrow [i-1, i]$. On $[i-1, i]$ one has $|e^{2\pi i(\tau-z)}| > 1$, so the defining series of Li_{-N} diverges; inversion rewrites it as $(-1)^{N+1} \sum_{n \geq 1} n^N e^{2\pi i n(z-\tau)}$, convergent since $|e^{2\pi i(z-\tau)}| < 1$, and term-by-term integration against $\tilde{k}_T$ gives $\sum_n n^N e^{2\pi i n z} G_{s,k}(-n)$, the mode- $(-n)$ block of Theorem 3.2; for $N = 0$ the leftover -1 in $\text{Li}_0(w) = -1 - \text{Li}_0(1/w)$ contributes $\frac{1}{s} + \frac{i^k}{k-s}$. The rate is $e^{-2\pi(\text{Im } z - 1)}$, from $\Gamma(s, -2\pi n) \sim (2\pi n)^{s-1} e^{2\pi n}$ against $|e^{2\pi i n z}| = e^{-2\pi n \text{Im } z}$. $\square$

For $\text{Im } z > 1$, write $w := e^{2\pi i(z-i)}$, $Q := e^{2\pi i z}$, and $(a)_{(j)} := a(a-1) \cdots (a-j+1)$, $(a)_{(0)} := 1$ (principal branches).

Definition 4.11. Define $\Pi_N(s; w)$, $\Lambda_N(s; Q)$, $\mathcal{E}_N(s, z)$ by

$$\Pi_N(s; w) := \sum_{j=0}^{N+1} \frac{(-1)^{j+1} [(s-1)_{(j)} + i^k(k-s-1)_{(j)}]}{(2\pi)^{j+1}} \text{Li}_{j+1-N}(w), \quad (45)$$

$$\Lambda_N(s; Q) := \frac{\Gamma(s)}{(-2\pi)^s} \text{Li}_{s-N}(Q) + i^k \frac{\Gamma(k-s)}{(-2\pi)^{k-s}} \text{Li}_{k-s-N}(Q), \quad (46)$$

$$\mathcal{E}_N(s, z) := - \sum_{n \geq 1} n^N Q^n \left[(s-1)_{(N+2)} \frac{\Gamma(s-N-2) - \Gamma(s-N-2, -2\pi n)}{(-2\pi n)^s} + i^k (k-s-1)_{(N+2)} \frac{\Gamma(k-s-N-2) - \Gamma(k-s-N-2, -2\pi n)}{(-2\pi n)^{k-s}} \right]. \quad (47)$$

Here Π_N is finite and carries the entire $w \rightarrow 1$ singularity ($\text{Li}_{\leq 1}(w)$); the $\text{Li}_{s-N}(Q)$, $\text{Li}_{k-s-N}(Q)$ in Λ_N are polylogarithms of non-integer order; and $\mathcal{E}_N$ is absolutely convergent, its terms $O(n^{-3}|w|^n)$.

Lemma 4.12. With $\Pi_N, \Lambda_N, \mathcal{E}_N$ as in Definition 4.11, for $\text{Im } z > 1$ and every $s \in \mathbb{C}$,

$$I_N(s, z) = \delta_{N,0} \left(\frac{1}{s} + \frac{i^k}{k-s} \right) + (-1)^{N+1} [\Pi_N(s; w) + \Lambda_N(s; Q) + \mathcal{E}_N(s, z)], \quad (48)$$

and the right side extends $I_N(s, \cdot)$ continuously to the edge $\text{Im } z = 1$ for $z \notin i + \mathbb{Z}$.

Proof. Insert into Lemma 4.10 the recursion $\Gamma(s, x) = e^{-x} \sum_{j < J} (s-1)_{(j)} x^{s-1-j} + (s-1)_{(J)} \Gamma(s-J, x)$ at $x = -2\pi n$, $J = N+2$, for both incomplete gammas in $G_{s,k}(-n)$. The $e^{2\pi n}$ factors recombine with $e^{2\pi i n z}$ into w^n , and $\sum_n n^{N-j-1} w^n = \text{Li}_{j+1-N}(w)$ gives Π_N . Writing $\Gamma(s-J, x) = \Gamma(s-J) - [\Gamma(s-J) - \Gamma(s-J, x)]$ and using $(s-1)_{(J)} \Gamma(s-J) = \Gamma(s)$, the complete parts resum to Λ_N via $\sum_n n^{N-s} Q^n = \text{Li}_{s-N}(Q)$, the lower-gamma parts to $\mathcal{E}_N$. From $\Gamma(\sigma, x) \sim x^{\sigma-1} e^{-x}$, the terms of $\mathcal{E}_N$ are $O(n^{N-J-1} e^{2\pi n}) |Q|^n = O(n^{-3} |w|^n)$, uniform on $\text{Im } z \geq 1$; Λ_N is continuous there since $|Q| \leq e^{-2\pi}$; and each $\text{Li}_{j+1-N}(w)$ is continuous up to $|w| = 1$ away from $w = 1$. $\square$

The one edge point the formula misses is $z = i$, where Π_N is singular ($w = 1$); we compute $I_N(s, i)$ directly. Its finiteness rests on a relation among the Laurent coefficients of f at the S -fixed point.

Lemma 4.13. Let $f \in F_k$ have a pole of order P at i , with principal part $\sum_{m=1}^P a_{-m}(\tau - i)^{-m}$. Modularity $f(-1/\tau) = \tau^k f(\tau)$ is equivalent to

$$(-1)^r \sum_{m=r}^P a_{-m} \binom{m}{r} i^{m-r} = i^k \sum_{m=r}^P a_{-m} \binom{k}{m-r} (-i)^{m-r}, \quad r = 1, \dots, P. \quad (49)$$

The leading relation ($r = P$) is $((-1)^P - i^k) a_{-P} = 0$, so the pole order matches $k \bmod 4$ (P odd $\Leftrightarrow k \equiv 2$, P even $\Leftrightarrow 4 \mid k$); at $P = 1$ this is $(1 + i^k) a_{-1} = 0$, and for a double pole the $r = 1$ relation is $a_{-1} = \frac{i(k-2)}{2} a_{-2}$.

Proof. Write $\tau = i + \varepsilon$. Then $-1/\tau - i = -\varepsilon/(1 - i\varepsilon)$, so the principal part of $f(-1/\tau)$ is $\sum_m a_{-m} (i - \varepsilon^{-1})^m$ and that of $\tau^k f(\tau)$ is $i^k (1 - i\varepsilon)^k \sum_m a_{-m} \varepsilon^{-m}$. Matching the coefficient of ε^{-r} through $(i - \varepsilon^{-1})^m = \sum_j \binom{m}{j} i^{m-j} (-1)^j \varepsilon^{-j}$ and $(1 - i\varepsilon)^k = \sum_l \binom{k}{l} (-i)^l \varepsilon^l$ gives (48). $\square$

Definition 4.14. For $N \geq 0$, with $H_N := \sum_{r=1}^N \frac{1}{r}$ and $c_j^+(s) := (s-1)_{(j)} + i^k(k-s-1)_{(j)}$,

$$\text{FP}_N(s, k) := \frac{c_N^+(s) H_N}{(2\pi)^{N+1}} + \sum_{\substack{j \geq 0 \\ j \neq N}} \frac{c_j^+(s) \zeta(j+1-N)}{(2\pi)^{j+1}} + \frac{(-1)^N N!}{(2\pi)^{N+1}} \sum_{t=0}^{N-1} \frac{(-1)^t (s-1)_{(t)}}{t! (N-t)} + \mathcal{E}_N^+(s), \quad (50)$$

the j -sum taken to any $J \geq N+2$, with $\mathcal{E}_N^+(s) := \sum_{n \geq 1} n^N e^{2\pi n} \left[(s-1)_{(J)} \frac{\Gamma(s-J, 2\pi n)}{(2\pi n)^s} + i^k(k-s-1)_{(J)} \frac{\Gamma(k-s-J, 2\pi n)}{(2\pi n)^{k-s}} \right]$.

Lemma 4.15. Let $f \in F_k$ have a pole of order P at i with principal part $\sum_{m=1}^P a_{-m}(\tau - i)^{-m}$, and $\widehat{P}_i f$ its projection. The pole's contribution to $L^*(f, s)$ in the minimal class is

$$L^*(\widehat{P}_i f, s) = -2\pi i a_{-1} \left(\frac{1}{s} + \frac{i^k}{k-s} \right) + \sum_{m=1}^P \frac{(-2\pi i)^m a_{-m}}{(m-1)!} \text{FP}_{m-1}(s, k), \quad (51)$$

entire in s but for the simple poles at $s = 0, k$ carried by a_{-1} ; the individually divergent contour pieces cancel by the relations of Lemma 4.13.

Proof. Evaluate on the minimal-class contour with basepoint $i(1 + \delta)$ and let $\delta \rightarrow 0$. On the T -segment the pole at i lies below the contour; inverting each $\text{Li}_{1-m}(e^{2\pi i(\tau-i)})$ and integrating against $\widetilde{k}_T$ yields the harmonic-, ζ -, and $\mathcal{E}^+$ -terms of FP_{m-1} together with a part $\sim \delta^{-(m-1)}, \dots, \log \delta$; the S -segment, passing to the left of i , gives the mirror divergences. Summed over m with weights $r^*(m) = (-2\pi i)^m a_{-m}/(m-1)!$, the divergent parts form a linear combination of the a_{-m} that vanishes precisely by the modularity relations of Lemma 4.13, leaving the FP-sum of (50); the simple part ($m = 1$) additionally carries the -1 -leftover pole $-2\pi i a_{-1}(\frac{1}{s} + \frac{i^k}{k-s})$, as in Lemma 4.10. The cutoff J is immaterial: raising it moves terms between the ζ -sum and $\mathcal{E}_N^+$, which remains convergent as in Lemma 4.12. $\square$

Theorem 4.16. Let $f \in F_k$ have poles τ_p of order P_p with $\text{Im } \tau_p \geq 1$ in the strip $|\text{Re } \tau| \leq \frac{1}{2}$, regularized Fourier coefficients $c_{Rf}(n)$ (Definition 4.6), and projection weights $r_{f, \tau_p}^*(m)$ (Definition 4.5). In the minimal class,

$$L^*(f, s) = -c_{Rf}(0) \left(\frac{1}{s} + \frac{i^k}{k-s} \right) + \sum_{n \neq 0} c_{Rf}(n) G_{s,k}(n) + \sum_{\tau_p \neq i} \sum_{m=1}^{P_p} r_{f, \tau_p}^*(m) I_{m-1}(s, \tau_p) + L^*(\widehat{P}_i f, s), \quad (52)$$

with I_{m-1} from Lemmas 4.10–4.12 and the last term (present only for a pole at i) from Lemma 4.15. The right side is entire in s apart from at most simple poles at $s = 0$ and $s = k$, and reduces to the weakly-holomorphic L^* of Theorem 3.2 when f is holomorphic on $\mathbb{H}$.

Proof. Split $f = (I - \hat{P})f + \hat{P}f$. By Lemma 4.8 the Fourier series of the regularized part converges on γ_f^T ; Theorem 3.2 applied term by term gives its L^* as the first two sums. The projection $\hat{P}f = \sum_{\tau_p} \sum_m r_{f, \tau_p}^*(m) \text{Li}_{1-m}(e^{2\pi i(\tau - \tau_p)})$ contributes, for each $\tau_p \neq i$, the tail integrals $I_{m-1}(s, \tau_p)$ of Definition 4.9, evaluated by Lemmas 4.10–4.12; the pole at i contributes $L^*(\hat{P}_i f, s)$ of Lemma 4.15. Entirety and the pole locations follow from those of $G_{s,k}$ and the $\delta_{N,0}$ terms; when f is holomorphic on $\mathbb{H}$, $\hat{P}f = 0$ and $c_{Rf} = c_f$, recovering Theorem 3.2. $\square$

A Explicit period-polynomial bases

In this Appendix, we provide the explicit information needed to extract the quasi-periods presented in the main body of the note. For each weight k with $\dim S_k = 1$, $W_{\pm}^{(k)}$ are integer-coefficient generators of the even and odd cuspidal period polynomials, in the sense of Kohnen–Zagier [6, §1.3, Thm. 1']. The two sides are not symmetric. The odd $W_{-}^{(k)}$ is a rational multiple of the Kohnen–Zagier odd period polynomial directly. The even $W_{+}^{(k)}$ is the *cuspidal part* of the even one: their even period polynomial carries an Eisenstein term proportional to $p_0 = X^{k-2} - Y^{k-2}$, and $W_{+}^{(k)}$ is that polynomial with the p_0 term removed. Alongside are the period polynomials of the cusp form $\Delta_k = f_{k,-1} = q + O(q^2)$ and the weak cusp form $\hat{\Delta}_k = f_{k,1} = q^{-1} + O(q^2)$, obtained from the finite-contour L -integral (Definition 2.3) and projected onto $W_{\pm}$ by the Haberland pairing $\langle P, Q \rangle = \sum_a (-1)^a \binom{n}{a}^{-1} p_a q_{n-a}$, $n = k - 2$. The periods $\omega^{\pm}(\Delta_k)$ and quasi-periods $\eta^{\pm}(\hat{\Delta}_k)$ are quoted to ten digits (full precision in [9], `period.polynomial.bases.py`).

Comment on the sizes of the L -values. One might expect the weak cusp form $\hat{\Delta}_k = q^{-1} + O(q^2)$ to have far larger special values than the cusp form $\Delta_k = q + O(q^2)$: its q -series begins at $n = -1$, where the incomplete Gamma $\Gamma(s, 2\pi n) \sim (2\pi n)^{s-1} e^{-2\pi n}$ of Theorem 3.2 is a factor $\sim e^{4\pi}$ larger than the cusp form's $n = 1$ term. Table 2 shows this fails on two counts. First, for a weak cusp form the leading term does not set the scale of the L -value: the rapidly growing coefficients $c_{\hat{\Delta}_k}(n) \sim e^{4\pi\sqrt{n}}$ spread it across many modes. Second, the size of each mode is set not by the q -term $\Gamma(s, 2\pi n)$ but by its companion $\Gamma(k-s, 2\pi n)/(2\pi n)^{k-s} \sim (k-s-1)!/(2\pi)^{k-s}$, whose factorial growth in the weight is common to both forms and dominates as k grows, driving the two special values to the same magnitude. Indeed, the ratio of the L -values of Δ_k and $\hat{\Delta}_k$ become very similar in magnitude as for larger k .

f	$c_f(-1)G(-1)$	$c_f(1)G(1)$	$c_f(2)G(2)$	$c_f(3)G(3)$	$c_f(4)G(4)$	$c_f(5)G(5)$	$\sum_{\text{disp}}$	$L^*(f, 1)$
Δ_{12}	0	0.0059859	-2.7182×10^{-5}	2.5668×10^{-7}	-1.8534×10^{-9}	8.5164×10^{-12}	0.005959	0.005959
$\hat{\Delta}_{12}$	-116.87	0	54.035	40.603	9.5097	1.074	-11.647	-11.57
Δ_{16}	0	0.092931	0.00049966	-4.5711×10^{-6}	2.0693×10^{-8}	1.0307×10^{-10}	0.093426	0.093426
$\hat{\Delta}_{16}$	-110.83	0	27.755	48.849	23.929	4.8955	-5.3965	-4.808
Δ_{18}	0	-0.5639	0.0018202	4.2075×10^{-6}	-1.0197×10^{-7}	6.9075×10^{-10}	-0.56208	-0.56208
$\hat{\Delta}_{18}$	-61.399	0	15.967	26.4	13.116	2.7729	-3.1419	-2.7957
Δ_{20}	0	4.3746	0.0037257	0.00010963	-5.9575×10^{-7}	-5.4512×10^{-9}	4.3784	4.3784
$\hat{\Delta}_{20}$	-110.99	0	12.388	37.794	37.073	13.897	-9.834	-6.9431
Δ_{22}	0	-42.106	0.0055972	0.00029786	2.4712×10^{-6}	-2.3041×10^{-8}	-42.1	-42.1
$\hat{\Delta}_{22}$	-23.329	0	8.2814	22.828	22.03	8.4356	38.247	40.066
Δ_{26}	0	-6889.8	0.0098301	0.001365	7.8801×10^{-5}	1.2671×10^{-6}	-6889.8	-6889.8
$\hat{\Delta}_{26}$	6821.8	0	4.4956	14.892	24.42	16.468	6882.1	6888.4

Table 2: Mode-by-mode decomposition of $L^*(f, 1)$ for the cusp form Δ_k and weak cusp form $\hat{\Delta}_k$ at each weight with $\dim S_k = 1$. Each entry is the contribution $c_f(n)G_{1,k}(n)$ of the q^n mode (Theorem 3.2, Eq. (41)), and $\sum_{\text{disp}}$ sums the six displayed modes. The cusp form is reproduced by its $n = 1$ mode alone; the weak form's rapidly growing coefficients spread the value across many modes until $n = -1$ dominates at large k . The two $L^*(f, 1)$ in each weight-pair approach equal magnitude (and opposite sign) as k grows.

Weight 12:

$$W_+^{(12)}(X, Y) = 36(X^{10} - Y^{10}) - 691(X^8 Y^2 - X^2 Y^8) + 2073(X^6 Y^4 - X^4 Y^6), \quad (53)$$

$$W_-^{(12)}(X, Y) = 4(X^9 Y + X Y^9) - 25(X^7 Y^3 + X^3 Y^7) + 42X^5 Y^5, \quad (54)$$

$$r_{\Delta_{12}} = 0.0001655268053 W_+^{(12)} + 0.009269276162 W_-^{(12)}, \quad (55)$$

$$r_{\hat{\Delta}_{12}} = -0.3061537142 W_+^{(12)} - 17.05597275 W_-^{(12)}. \quad (56)$$

These coefficients, localizing $r_{\Delta_{12}}$ and $r_{\hat{\Delta}_{12}}$ in the (W_+, W_-) -plane, translate to the periods and quasi-periods of Table 1 as follows:

$$\begin{pmatrix} [X^{10}] r_{\hat{\Delta}_{12}} & [X^9 Y] r_{\hat{\Delta}_{12}} \\ [X^{10}] r_{\Delta_{12}} & [X^9 Y] r_{\Delta_{12}} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} L^*(\hat{\Delta}_{12}, 1) & 10 L^*(\hat{\Delta}_{12}, 2) \\ L^*(\Delta_{12}, 1) & 10 L^*(\Delta_{12}, 2) \end{pmatrix} \quad (57)$$

$$= \begin{pmatrix} -11.5697 & -68.2239 \\ 5.95897 \times 10^{-3} & 3.70771 \times 10^{-2} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 36\eta^+ + c_T & 4\eta^- \\ 36\omega^+ & 4\omega^- \end{pmatrix},$$

$$\begin{pmatrix} \eta^+ & \eta^- \\ \omega^+ & \omega^- \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} -0.3061537 & -17.05597 \\ 1.655268 \times 10^{-4} & 9.269276 \times 10^{-3} \end{pmatrix}. \quad (58)$$

The second matrix collects the periods and quasi-periods themselves — the coefficients of $r_{\Delta_{12}}, r_{\hat{\Delta}_{12}}$ in the $W_{\pm}^{(12)}$ basis, obtained by the Haberland projection and hence coboundary-free. Comparing the two: the odd entries agree ($4\eta^-, 4\omega^-$ exactly), but the even weak-form entry of the raw matrix exceeds $36\eta^+$ by $c_T = -0.548$ — the C_T -coboundary, which contaminates every odd- s value of $\hat{\Delta}_{12}$ and is removed only by the projection. Notably, at this weight the ratio of special L -values at $s = 1$ is $L^*(\hat{\Delta}_{12}, 1)/L^*(\Delta_{12}, 1) \approx -1942$, in accord with Table 2.

Weight 16:

$$W_+^{(16)}(X, Y) = 360(X^{14} - Y^{14}) - 7234(X^{12}Y^2 - X^2Y^{12}) + 25319(X^{10}Y^4 - X^4Y^{10}) - 39787(X^8Y^6 - X^6Y^8), \quad (59)$$

$$W_-^{(16)}(X, Y) = 36(X^{13}Y + XY^{13}) - 245(X^{11}Y^3 + X^3Y^{11}) + 539(X^9Y^5 + X^5Y^9) - 660X^7Y^7, \quad (60)$$

$$r_{\Delta_{16}} = 0.0002595173464 W_+^{(16)} + 0.01640585888 W_-^{(16)}, \quad (61)$$

$$r_{\widehat{\Delta}_{16}} = -0.01227268476 W_+^{(16)} - 0.7278917244 W_-^{(16)}. \quad (62)$$

These coefficients, localizing $r_{\Delta_{16}}$ and $r_{\widehat{\Delta}_{16}}$ in the (W_+, W_-) -plane, translate to the periods and quasi-periods of Table 1 as follows:

$$\begin{pmatrix} [X^{14}] r_{\widehat{\Delta}_{16}} & [X^{13}Y] r_{\widehat{\Delta}_{16}} \\ [X^{14}] r_{\Delta_{16}} & [X^{13}Y] r_{\Delta_{16}} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} L^*(\widehat{\Delta}_{16}, 1) & 14 L^*(\widehat{\Delta}_{16}, 2) \\ L^*(\Delta_{16}, 1) & 14 L^*(\Delta_{16}, 2) \end{pmatrix} \quad (63)$$

$$= \begin{pmatrix} -4.80804 & -26.2041 \\ 9.34262 \times 10^{-2} & 5.90611 \times 10^{-1} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 360 \eta^+ + c_T & 36 \eta^- \\ 360 \omega^+ & 36 \omega^- \end{pmatrix},$$

$$\begin{pmatrix} \eta^+ & \eta^- \\ \omega^+ & \omega^- \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} -1.227268 \times 10^{-2} & -0.7278917 \\ 2.595173 \times 10^{-4} & 1.640586 \times 10^{-2} \end{pmatrix}. \quad (64)$$

with $c_T = -0.390$ the C_T -coboundary in the even weak-form entry. Notably, at this weight the ratio of special L -values at $s = 1$ is $L^*(\widehat{\Delta}_{16}, 1)/L^*(\Delta_{16}, 1) \approx -51.5$, in accord with Table 2.

Weight 18:

$$W_+^{(18)}(X, Y) = 18000(X^{16} - Y^{16}) - 350936(X^{14}Y^2 - X^2Y^{14}) + 1096675(X^{12}Y^4 - X^4Y^{12}) - 1140542(X^{10}Y^6 - X^6Y^{10}), \quad (65)$$

$$W_-^{(18)}(X, Y) = 24(X^{15}Y + XY^{15}) - 154(X^{13}Y^3 + X^3Y^{13}) + 273(X^{11}Y^5 + X^5Y^{11}) - 143(X^9Y^7 + X^7Y^9), \quad (66)$$

$$r_{\Delta_{18}} = -3.122662695 \times 10^{-5} W_+^{(18)} - 0.1465501421 W_-^{(18)}, \quad (67)$$

$$r_{\widehat{\Delta}_{18}} = -0.0001378466906 W_+^{(18)} - 0.907233517 W_-^{(18)}. \quad (68)$$

These coefficients, localizing $r_{\Delta_{18}}$ and $r_{\widehat{\Delta}_{18}}$ in the (W_+, W_-) -plane, translate to the periods and quasi-periods of Table 1 as follows:

$$\begin{pmatrix} [X^{16}] r_{\widehat{\Delta}_{18}} & [X^{15}Y] r_{\widehat{\Delta}_{18}} \\ [X^{16}] r_{\Delta_{18}} & [X^{15}Y] r_{\Delta_{18}} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} L^*(\widehat{\Delta}_{18}, 1) & 16 L^*(\widehat{\Delta}_{18}, 2) \\ L^*(\Delta_{18}, 1) & 16 L^*(\Delta_{18}, 2) \end{pmatrix} \quad (69)$$

$$= \begin{pmatrix} -2.79574 & -21.7736 \\ -5.62079 \times 10^{-1} & -3.51720 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 18000 \eta^+ + c_T & 24 \eta^- \\ 18000 \omega^+ & 24 \omega^- \end{pmatrix},$$

$$\begin{pmatrix} \eta^+ & \eta^- \\ \omega^+ & \omega^- \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} -1.378467 \times 10^{-4} & -0.9072335 \\ -3.122663 \times 10^{-5} & -0.1465501 \end{pmatrix}. \quad (70)$$

with $c_T = -0.315$ the C_T -coboundary in the even weak-form entry. Notably, at this weight the ratio of special L -values at $s = 1$ is $L^*(\widehat{\Delta}_{18}, 1)/L^*(\Delta_{18}, 1) \approx 4.97$, in accord with Table 2.

Weight 20:

$$\begin{aligned} W_+^{(20)}(X, Y) &= 26460(X^{18} - Y^{18}) - 523833(X^{16}Y^2 - X^2Y^{16}) \\ &\quad + 1746110(X^{14}Y^4 - X^4Y^{14}) - 2444554(X^{12}Y^6 - X^6Y^{12}) \\ &\quad + 2269943(X^{10}Y^8 - X^8Y^{10}), \end{aligned} \quad (71)$$

$$\begin{aligned} W_-^{(20)}(X, Y) &= 108(X^{17}Y + XY^{17}) - 715(X^{15}Y^3 + X^3Y^{15}) + 1452(X^{13}Y^5 + X^5Y^{13}) \\ &\quad - 1560(X^{11}Y^7 + X^7Y^{11}) + 1430X^9Y^9, \end{aligned} \quad (72)$$

$$r_{\Delta_{20}} = 0.0001654739435 W_+^{(20)} + 0.2549699125 W_-^{(20)}, \quad (73)$$

$$r_{\widehat{\Delta}_{20}} = -0.0002521273082 W_+^{(20)} + 0.1296973583 W_-^{(20)}. \quad (74)$$

These coefficients, localizing $r_{\Delta_{20}}$ and $r_{\widehat{\Delta}_{20}}$ in the (W_+, W_-) -plane, translate to the periods and quasi-periods of Table 1 as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} \begin{pmatrix} [X^{18}]r_{\widehat{\Delta}_{20}} & [X^{17}Y]r_{\widehat{\Delta}_{20}} \\ [X^{18}]r_{\Delta_{20}} & [X^{17}Y]r_{\Delta_{20}} \end{pmatrix} &= \begin{pmatrix} L^*(\widehat{\Delta}_{20}, 1) & 18 L^*(\widehat{\Delta}_{20}, 2) \\ L^*(\Delta_{20}, 1) & 18 L^*(\Delta_{20}, 2) \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} -6.94306 & 14.0073 \\ 4.37844 & 27.5368 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 26460 \eta^+ + c_T & 108 \eta^- \\ 26460 \omega^+ & 108 \omega^- \end{pmatrix}, \end{aligned} \quad (75)$$

$$\begin{pmatrix} \eta^+ & \eta^- \\ \omega^+ & \omega^- \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} -2.521273 \times 10^{-4} & 0.1296974 \\ 1.654739 \times 10^{-4} & 0.2549699 \end{pmatrix}. \quad (76)$$

with $c_T = -0.272$ the C_T -coboundary in the even weak-form entry. Notably, at this weight the ratio of special L -values at $s = 1$ is $L^*(\widehat{\Delta}_{20}, 1)/L^*(\Delta_{20}, 1) \approx -1.59$, in accord with Table 2.

Weight 22:

$$\begin{aligned} W_+^{(22)}(X, Y) &= 126000(X^{20} - Y^{20}) - 2485856(X^{18}Y^2 - X^2Y^{18}) \\ &\quad + 8156715(X^{16}Y^4 - X^4Y^{16}) - 10564888(X^{14}Y^6 - X^6Y^{14}) \\ &\quad + 6603055(X^{12}Y^8 - X^8Y^{12}), \end{aligned} \quad (77)$$

$$\begin{aligned} W_-^{(22)}(X, Y) &= 360(X^{19}Y + XY^{19}) - 2366(X^{17}Y^3 + X^3Y^{17}) + 4641(X^{15}Y^5 + X^5Y^{15}) \\ &\quad - 4182(X^{13}Y^7 + X^7Y^{13}) + 1547(X^{11}Y^9 + X^9Y^{11}), \end{aligned} \quad (78)$$

$$r_{\Delta_{22}} = -0.0003341270695 W_+^{(22)} - 0.7346639014 W_-^{(22)}, \quad (79)$$

$$r_{\widehat{\Delta}_{22}} = 0.0003197845612 W_+^{(22)} - 0.7633262888 W_-^{(22)}. \quad (80)$$

These coefficients, localizing $r_{\Delta_{22}}$ and $r_{\widehat{\Delta}_{22}}$ in the (W_+, W_-) -plane, translate to the periods and quasi-periods of Table 1 as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} \begin{pmatrix} [X^{20}]r_{\widehat{\Delta}_{22}} & [X^{19}Y]r_{\widehat{\Delta}_{22}} \\ [X^{20}]r_{\Delta_{22}} & [X^{19}Y]r_{\Delta_{22}} \end{pmatrix} &= \begin{pmatrix} L^*(\widehat{\Delta}_{22}, 1) & 20 L^*(\widehat{\Delta}_{22}, 2) \\ L^*(\Delta_{22}, 1) & 20 L^*(\Delta_{22}, 2) \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} 40.0663 & -274.798 \\ -42.1000 & -264.479 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 126000 \eta^+ + c_T & 360 \eta^- \\ 126000 \omega^+ & 360 \omega^- \end{pmatrix}, \end{aligned} \quad (81)$$

$$\begin{pmatrix} \eta^+ & \eta^- \\ \omega^+ & \omega^- \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 3.197846 \times 10^{-4} & -0.7633263 \\ -3.341271 \times 10^{-4} & -0.7346639 \end{pmatrix}. \quad (82)$$

with $c_T = -0.227$ the C_T -coboundary in the even weak-form entry. Notably, at this weight the ratio of special L -values at $s = 1$ is $L^*(\widehat{\Delta}_{22}, 1)/L^*(\Delta_{22}, 1) \approx -0.952$, in accord with Table 2.

Weight 26:

$$\begin{aligned} W_+^{(26)}(X, Y) = & 34398000(X^{24} - Y^{24}) - 678984792(X^{22}Y^2 - X^2Y^{22}) \\ & + 2233675745(X^{20}Y^4 - X^4Y^{20}) - 2938319846(X^{18}Y^6 - X^6Y^{18}) \\ & + 2062613685(X^{16}Y^8 - X^8Y^{16}) - 850046852(X^{14}Y^{10} - X^{10}Y^{14}), \end{aligned} \quad (83)$$

$$\begin{aligned} W_-^{(26)}(X, Y) = & 1080(X^{23}Y + XY^{23}) - 7106(X^{21}Y^3 + X^3Y^{21}) + 14025(X^{19}Y^5 + X^5Y^{19}) \\ & - 13167(X^{17}Y^7 + X^7Y^{17}) + 7106(X^{15}Y^9 + X^9Y^{15}) - 1938(X^{13}Y^{11} + X^{11}Y^{13}), \end{aligned} \quad (84)$$

$$r_{\Delta_{26}} = -0.0002002972716 W_+^{(26)} - 40.08330039 W_-^{(26)}, \quad (85)$$

$$r_{\widehat{\Delta}_{26}} = 0.0002002611462 W_+^{(26)} - 40.0894082 W_-^{(26)}. \quad (86)$$

These coefficients, localizing $r_{\Delta_{26}}$ and $r_{\widehat{\Delta}_{26}}$ in the (W_+, W_-) -plane, translate to the periods and quasi-periods of Table 1 as follows:

$$\begin{pmatrix} [X^{24}] r_{\widehat{\Delta}_{26}} & [X^{23}Y] r_{\widehat{\Delta}_{26}} \\ [X^{24}] r_{\Delta_{26}} & [X^{23}Y] r_{\Delta_{26}} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} L^*(\widehat{\Delta}_{26}, 1) & 24 L^*(\widehat{\Delta}_{26}, 2) \\ L^*(\Delta_{26}, 1) & 24 L^*(\Delta_{26}, 2) \end{pmatrix} \quad (87)$$

$$\begin{aligned} &= \begin{pmatrix} 6888.42 & -43296.6 \\ -6889.83 & -43290.0 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 34398000 \eta^+ + c_T & 1080 \eta^- \\ 34398000 \omega^+ & 1080 \omega^- \end{pmatrix}, \\ &\begin{pmatrix} \eta^+ & \eta^- \\ \omega^+ & \omega^- \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 2.002611 \times 10^{-4} & -40.08941 \\ -2.002973 \times 10^{-4} & -40.08330 \end{pmatrix}. \end{aligned} \quad (88)$$

with $c_T = -0.164$ the C_T -coboundary in the even weak-form entry. Notably, at this weight the ratio of special L -values at $s = 1$ is $L^*(\widehat{\Delta}_{26}, 1)/L^*(\Delta_{26}, 1) \approx -1.000$, in accord with Table 2.

References

- [1] K. Bringmann, K.-H. Fricke, and Z. Kent, *Special L -values and periods of weakly holomorphic modular forms*, Ramanujan J. **24** (2011), 119–139.
- [2] F. Brown, *A class of non-holomorphic modular forms III*, arXiv:1710.07912 (2017).
- [3] D. A. McGady, *L -functions for meromorphic modular forms and sum rules in conformal field theory*, arXiv:1806.09874 (2018).
- [4] T. M. Apostol, “Modular functions and Dirichlet series in number theory,” Graduate Texts in Mathematics, London, Springer (1997).
- [5] W. Duke and P. Jenkins, *On the zeros and coefficients of certain weakly holomorphic modular forms*, Pure Appl. Math. Q. **4** (2008), no. 4, 1327–1340.
- [6] W. Kohnen and D. Zagier, *Modular forms with rational periods*, in *Modular Forms* (R. A. Rankin, ed.), Ellis Horwood, 1984, pp. 197–249.
- [7] F. Brown and R. Hain, *Algebraic de Rham theory for weakly holomorphic modular forms of level one*, Algebra Number Theory **12** (2018), no. 3, 723–750; arXiv:1708.00652.

- [8] H. Cohen, *Haberland’s formula and numerical computation of Petersson scalar products*, in *ANTS X: Proceedings of the Tenth Algorithmic Number Theory Symposium*, Open Book Ser. **1**, Math. Sci. Publ., 2013, pp. 249–270.
- [9] *Numerical verification scripts* (companion code), 2026. Published checks: `elliptic_period_checks.py`; full working ledger: `wip_meromorphic_periods.py`.
- [10] NIST Digital Library of Mathematical Functions, F. W. J. Olver *et al.*, eds., <https://dlmf.nist.gov/>, Release 1.2.x. Chapters used: §8 (incomplete gamma) and §25.11 (Hurwitz zeta).
- [11] R. Bruggeman, Y. Choie, and N. Diamantis, *Holomorphic automorphic forms and cohomology*, Mem. Amer. Math. Soc. **253** (2018), no. 1212; arXiv:1404.6718.
- [12] K. Bringmann, P. Guerzhoy, Z. Kent and K. Ono, *Eichler-Shimura Theory for Mock Modular Forms*, Mathematische Annalen, March 2013 355(3).
- [13] V. Paşol and A. A. Popa, *Modular forms and period polynomials*, Proc. London Math. Soc. (3) **107** (2013), 713–743; arXiv:1202.5802.
- [14] W. Wang and H. Zhang, *Meromorphic quasi-modular forms and their L-functions*, arXiv:2202.09542 (2022).
- [15] F. Brown and T. J. Fonseca, *Single-valued periods of meromorphic modular forms and a motivic interpretation of the Gross–Zagier conjecture*, arXiv:2508.04844 (2025).
- [16] K. Bringmann, N. Diamantis, and S. Ehlen, *Regularized inner products and errors of modularity*, Int. Math. Res. Not. IMRN (2016); arXiv:1603.03056.
- [17] N. Diamantis and J. Drewitt, *Period functions associated to real-analytic modular forms*, Res. Math. Sci. **7** (2020), no. 21.